



**ABANTU
ENVIRONMENTAL
SERVICES**



078 207 8278



info@abantuenvironmental.co.za

Fax : 086 685 9536

PROJECT NAME:

**PROPOSED CONSTRUCTION OF DUTYWA CONFERENCE CENTRE AND ASSOCIATED INFRASTRUCTURE
WITHIN THE MBHASHE LOCAL MUNICIPALITY, IN THE EASTERN CAPE.**

REPORT TITLE:

SITE SENSITIVITY VERIFICATION REPORT

DATE:

13 JULY 2026

PREPARED BY:

ABANTU ENVIRONMENTAL SERVICES (PTY) LTD



**ABANTU
ENVIRONMENTAL
SERVICES**

PREPARED FOR:

CHIMORA GROUP (PTY) LTD



ON BEHALF OF: MBHASHE LOCAL MUNICIPALITY



Mbhashe
Local Municipality
WILLOWVALE | DUTYWA | ELLIOTDALE

OFFICE	ADDRESS	CONTACT DETAILS
kKeiskammahoek	533 Masincedane Keiskammahoek 5670	Contact Person: Mr Sive Mlamla (Pr. Sci.Nat, Reg EAP) Cell: 078 207 8278 Fax: 086 685 9536 Tel: 041 582 2648 Email: info@abantuenvironmental.co.za Website: www.abantuenvironmental.co.za

SITE SENSITIVITY VERIFICATION REPORT: PROPOSED DUTYWA CONFERENCE CENTRE

DECLARATION OF INDEPENDENCE

I, Sive Mlamla, in my capacity as an EAP, hereby declare that I –

- Act as an independent consultant
- Do not have any financial interest in the undertaking of the activity, other than remuneration for the work performed
- Have and will not have vested interest in the activity
- Have no, and will not engage in, conflicting interests in the undertaking of the activity
- Undertake to disclose any material information that has or may have the potential to influence the decision of the competent authority or the objectivity of any report, plan, or document
- Will provide the competent authority with access to all information at my disposal regarding the report, whether such information is favourable to the Client or not
- Based on information provided to me by the Client and in addition to information obtained during the course of this study, have presented the results and conclusion within the associated document to the best of my professional ability
- Reserve the right to modify aspects pertaining to the present investigation should additional information become available through on-going research and/or further work in this field
- Undertake to have my work peer reviewed on a regular basis by a competent specialist.



Sive Mlamla (Pr.Sci.Nat, Reg. EAP(EAPASA))

Environmental Assessment Practitioner

SITE SENSITIVITY VERIFICATION REPORT: PROPOSED DUTYWA CONFERENCE CENTRE DETAILS AND EXPERTISE OF THE EAP

Abantu Environmental Services (Pty) Ltd has been appointed by Chimora Group on behalf of the Mbashe Local Municipality (MLM) to apply for an environmental authorisation for the proposed Dutywa conference centre, within the Mbashe Local Municipality. Refer to **Table 1** below for EAP's details.

Table 1. EAP Details

Environmental Assessment Practitioner:	Mr Sive Mlamla
Expertise:	Sive Mlamla is an environmental scientist with 11 years of experience in scientific research, lecturing and environmental consulting. His key expertise includes environmental impact assessments, environmental compliance auditing, waste planning, proposal & business development, project management, strategic planning, research design & execution, remote sensing & GIS applications for land use/cover change mapping and fluvial geomorphology. Qualifications • M.Sc. Geography (Catchment Hydrology) • B.Sc. Honours Environmental Geography • B.Sc. Environmental Sciences (Botany and Geography) Professional registrations: • Registered Professional Natural Scientist (Pr.Sci.Nat) - Reg. No. 118495 – SACNASP • Registered Environmental Assessment Practitioner (Reg. EAP (EAPASA)) - Reg. No. 2022/5204 Training: • Practical Implementation of Environmental Auditing and Monitoring (2025) • WET-Health Tool & WET-EcoServices for Level 1B and Level 2 assessment (2025) • WET-Health Tool for Level 1A assessment (2025) • Environmental Impact Assessments (2025) • Introduction to Synthetic Aperture Radar and Applications (2024) • Earth Observation Data Analysis with Google Earth Engine (2023) • People Management Skills (2017) • Biodiversity spatial data management, acquisition, and analysis (2018) • Water Use Licence Applications via e-WULAAS (2020) • Remote Sensing (land use/cover classification) and SWAT hydrologic modelling (2017) Registrations and memberships: • Member of the South African Wetlands Society Reg. No. S9BPP477 • Member of the Southern African Association of Geomorphologists • Institute of Waste Management of Southern Africa (IWMSA) Reg No. 40120001

TABLE OF CONTENTS

DECLARATION OF INDEPENDENCE	2
DETAILS AND EXPERTISE OF THE EAP	3
TABLE OF CONTENTS	4
LIST OF FIGURES	4
LIST OF TABLES	5
1. INTRODUCTION	6
2. PROJECT DESCRIPTION	7
3. LEGISLATIVE REQUIREMENTS	8
4. SITE SENSITIVITY VERIFICATION	9
4.1. METHODOLOGY	9
4.2. DESKTOP AND IN-SITU SITE ANALYSIS	10
4.2.1 CLIMATE	10
4.2.2 TOPOGRAPHY AND HYDROLOGY	10
4.2.3 GEOLOGY AND SOILS	14
4.2.4 ECOLOGY & BIODIVERSITY	14
4.2.5 SOCIO-ECONOMIC ASPECTS	18
4.2.6 CULTURAL HERITAGE SITE	19
4.2.7 LAND USE	19
4.3. SITE SENSITIVITIES IDENTIFIED (SCREENING TOOL)	21
4.4. SPECIALIST ASSESSMENTS IDENTIFIED	21
5. CONCLUSION	23
6. REFERENCES	25

LIST OF FIGURES

Figure 1. Locality map of the proposed conference centre and associated infrastructure.	6
Figure 2. Locality map of the proposed conference centre and associated infrastructure.	7
Figure 3. Elevation profile of the proposed conference centre and associated infrastructure.	10
Figure 4. Drainage line and surface water features around the development site.	11
Figure 5. The watercourse to be affected - upstream / north of the viewpoint.....	12
Figure 6. The river that the proposed sewer, water and stormwater pipeline will cross.....	13
Figure 7. The confluence where the Mputi river joins the Ngxakaxa river.	13
Figure 8. Vegetation map of the proposed conference centre and associated infrastructure.....	15
Figure 9. Vegetation conditions of the proposed conference site.	15
Figure 10. Terrestrial Biodiversity of the proposed conference centre and associated infrastructure.	16
Figure 11. Aquatic sensitivity of the proposed conference centre and associated infrastructure.	17
Figure 12. The river that the associated infrastructure will traverse.....	17
Figure 13. SAHRIS Palaeo map.	19
Figure 14. Gravel access road to the conference centre from N2.	20

SITE SENSITIVITY VERIFICATION REPORT: PROPOSED DUTYWA CONFERENCE CENTRE

Figure 15. Existing overhead powerlines within the vicinity of the proposed site..... 20

LIST OF TABLES

Table 1. EAP Details 3

Table 2. Site Sensitivities identified (Screening Tool)..... 21

Table 3. EAP response to specialist assessments identified in the screening tool report. 22

1. INTRODUCTION

Abantu Environmental Services (Pty) Ltd was appointed by Chimora Group (Pty) Ltd on behalf of the Mphashe Local Municipality to undertake the environmental impact assessment process for the proposed construction of a conference centre in Dutywa, within the Mphashe Local Municipality (Figure 1).

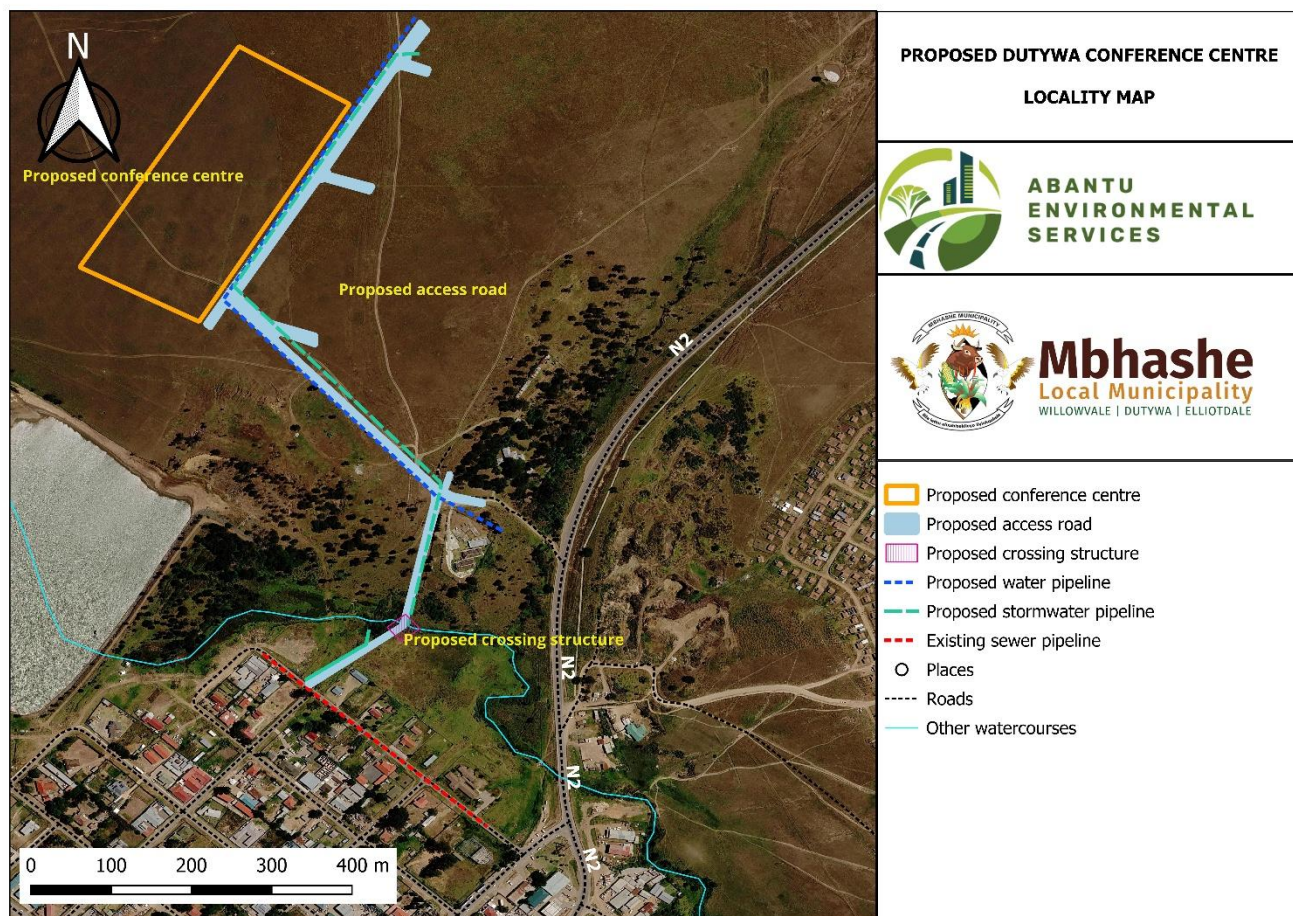


Figure 1. Locality map of the proposed conference centre and associated infrastructure.

The aim of this report is to verify land use and theme sensitivities as identified by the DFFE Screening Tool and also confirm the need for a particular specialist assessment(s) as indicated by the Screening Tool.

2. PROJECT DESCRIPTION

The proposed development comprises of the following:

- Proposed conference centre
- Proposed Sewer Pipe - 160mm Class 34 UPVC and Galvanised Steel Sewer Pipe
- Proposed Water Pipe - main - 8 m servitude
- Proposed Concrete Stormwater Pipes- 450mm – 600mm Ø 100D
- Proposed Sewer Manholes
- Proposed Sw Catchpit/Manhole
- **Proposed concrete/paved/tar access road and a crossing structure (bridge/culvert)**
 - 5960mm (5.96km) length
 - width of 3700mm x 2 lanes (7.4m + 1.65m = 9.5m)
 - shoulders including sidewalks;
 - side walks = 1200mm
 - stormwater drains and should of 465mm
 - **Layers works**
 - 60mm thick 35mpa interlocking brick
 - paving over 20mm compacted sand
 - 150mm g5 material stabilised with 3%
 - cement compacted to 98% mod aashto
 - 150mm g7 material compacted to
 - 95% mo150mm insitu compacted to
 - 93% mod aashtod aashto



Figure 2. Locality map of the proposed conference centre and associated infrastructure.

3. LEGISLATIVE REQUIREMENTS

The proposed development triggers listed activities of the NEMA EIR Regulations

- GNR 327 Activity 12 – the development of a crossing structure (culvert/bridge) with a footprint exceeding 100m²
- GNR 327 Activity 19 - excavations and infilling within the Mputi river
- GNR 327 Activity 24 – the development of a road wider than 13,5 meters and a length of approximately 5.9km
- GNR 327 Activity 27 – the development requires the clearance of an area more than a hectare but less than 20 hectares for the development of the conference centre
- GNR 327 Activity 28 – the development entails a footprint greater than 1 hectare, outside an urban area
- GNR 324 Activity 14 – manhole within the Mputi river under ESA 1

Section 21 water uses of the National Water Act, s21 (c) and (i) the Mputi river under ESA 1

The triggers warrant a Basic Assessment and a WULA, the sensitivities were confirmed by a site investigation conducted on 28 July 2026.

4. SITE SENSITIVITY VERIFICATION

On 20 March 2020 the Minister of Forestry, Fisheries and the Environmental published the general requirements for undertaking site sensitivity verification for environmental themes for activities requiring environmental authorization (Government Gazette No. 43110). In terms of these requirements, prior to commencing with a specialist assessment, the current land use and environmental sensitivity of the site under consideration by the screening tool must be confirmed by undertaking a site sensitivity verification.

In accordance with the Notice of the requirement to submit a report generated by the national web-based environmental screening tool in terms of section 24(5)(h) of the NEMA, 1998 (Act No 107 of 1998) and regulation 16(1)(b)(v) of the EIA regulations, 2014, as amended, a screening tool was generated and identified specific site sensitivities and themes to be assessed for this specific project. The specialist themes in section 1.4.3 were identified.

4.1. METHODOLOGY

The site sensitivity verification report compiled by Abantu Environmental Services' Lead EAP

The assessment has been compiled based on:

- A site investigation undertaken on 28 July 2026.
- A desktop investigation using biodiversity and land-use mapping tools such as inter alia BGIS and;
- Information recorded in Screening Report, Notice of Intent Report
- Information derived from available specialist assessment reports.

4.2. DESKTOP AND IN-SITU SITE ANALYSIS

4.2.1 CLIMATE

Dutywa is situated at an altitude of approximately 388m above sea level and receives approximately 530 – 540 mm of rainfall annually, with March being the wettest month. The area experiences a warm temperate climate with summer rainfall, characterized by warm summers and cool, dry winters. The warmest conditions are generally experienced during February, with an average midday temperature of about 25°C, while the coldest conditions occur during July, when average temperatures drop to around 18.3°C during the day and 5.1°C at night.

4.2.2 TOPOGRAPHY AND HYDROLOGY

The area is characterised by undulating to gently rolling inland terrain (see **Figure 3**), with the broader municipality displaying fragmented topography of open grasslands, valleys and river corridors. It is generally less rugged than the coastal parts although it is still associated with incised drainage lines, eroded slopes and uneven landforms in places (MLM IDP, 2023).

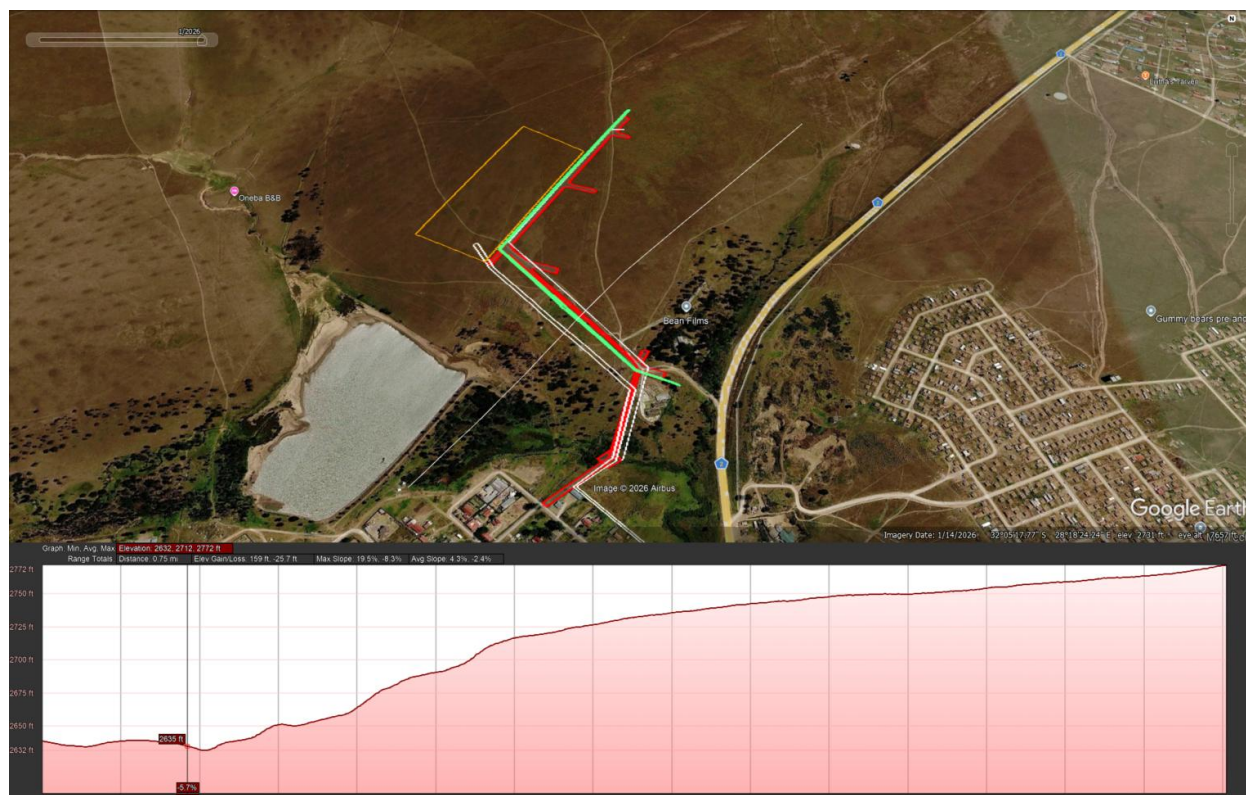


Figure 3. Elevation profile of the proposed conference centre and associated infrastructure.

The area falls within the Mzimvubu-Tsitsikama water management area and within the Mbashe river catchment system. Dutywa is located within the broader Mbashe river basin, where surface water drainage is influenced by a network of perennial and non-perennial streams, smaller drainage lines and associated

SITE SENSITIVITY VERIFICATION REPORT: PROPOSED DUTYWA CONFERENCE CENTRE

valley systems (**Figure 4**). The Mputi river forms the primary watercourse in the immediate vicinity of the project and is traversed by the proposed access road, where the crossing structure will be constructed. The proposed water, sewer and stormwater pipelines will also cross the Mputi river within the same infrastructure corridor (**Figure 6**). The Mputi river flows south-west of the development site, where it joins the Ngxakaxa river (**Figure 7**), and the combined flow subsequently discharges into the Nqabarha river further south, forming part of the broader Mbhashe river catchment.



Figure 4. Drainage line and surface water features around the development site.

Mputi river receiving environment, viewed from the bridge along N2 (Error! Reference source not found.).

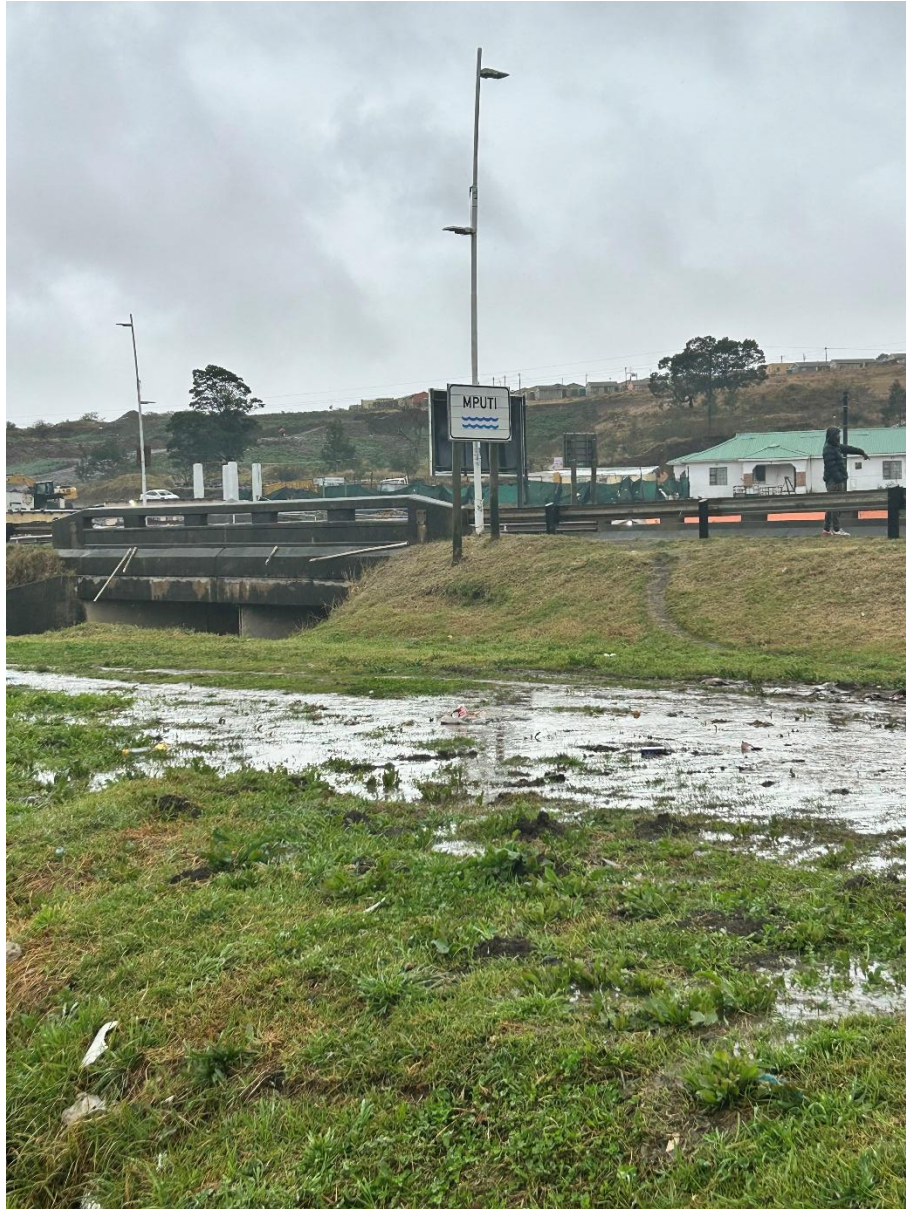


Figure 5. The watercourse to be affected - upstream / north of the viewpoint.



Figure 6. The river that the proposed sewer, water and stormwater pipeline will cross.



Figure 7. The confluence where the Mputi river joins the Ngxakaxa river.

4.2.3 GEOLOGY AND SOILS

The area is dominated by sedimentary rocks of the Karoo Supergroup, mainly of Late Permian to Early Triassic age, together with younger Jurassic dolerite intrusions. The area is predominantly underlain by the Beaufort Group, particularly the Adelaide Subgroup. The broader Dutywa area is also associated with the Katberg Formation of the Tarkastad Subgroup, which generally comprises of red and greenish-grey mudstone with subordinate fine-to-medium grained sandstone. In some parts of the wider Dutywa area, younger alluvial deposits are also associated with drainage lines and river valleys.

The soils in the Dutywa area are generally derived from the weathering of the underlying mudstone, sandstone and dolerite, and are typically shallow to moderately deep, depending on slope and proximity to drainage features. These soils may be prone to erosion where vegetation has been disturbed or where they occur on steeper slopes, while deeper alluvial soils may occur along valley bottoms.

4.2.4 ECOLOGY & BIODIVERSITY

According to SANBI, the proposed conference centre and its associated infrastructure traverses vegetation classified as the Mthatha Moist Grassland (**Figure 8**), which falls under the Grassland Biome. This vegetation type is typically made up of species-poor, sour, wiry grassland with *Eragrostis plana* and *Sporobolus africanus*. The grassland is in good condition, but likely to be dominated by *Themeda triandra* (Mucina et al., 2006). According to the Revised National Ecosystem List (2022), the Mthatha Moist Grassland is listed as Endangered. The proposed development footprint extends the built-up urban area north-eastward across undeveloped grassland towards the proposed conference centre. Its access road crosses the Mputi river, which may support more moisture-dependent vegetation and locally higher ecological sensitive vegetation. According to the Eastern Cape Biodiversity Conservation Plan (2019), the proposed development falls within CBA 2 and ESA 1, indicating areas of ecological sensitivity, although parts of the development footprint are moderately transformed by informal tracks.

SITE SENSITIVITY VERIFICATION REPORT: PROPOSED DUTYWA CONFERENCE CENTRE

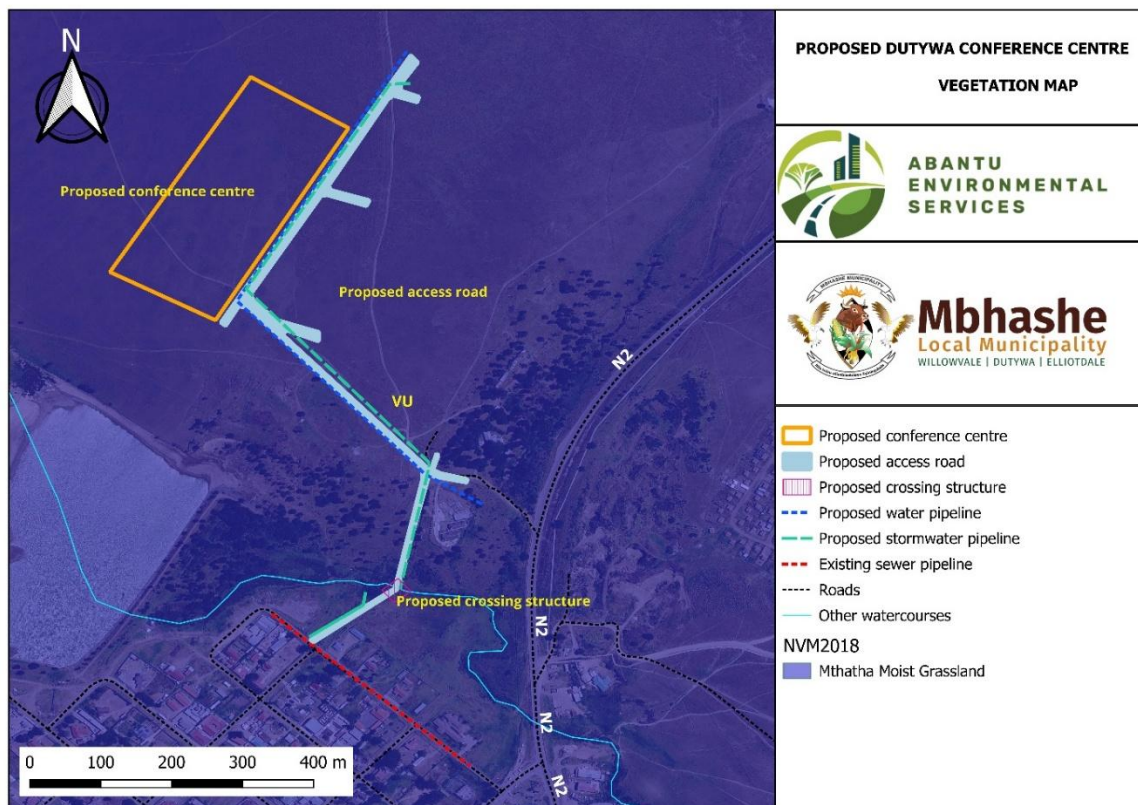


Figure 8. Vegetation map of the proposed conference centre and associated infrastructure.

According to the National Screening Tool, the plant sensitivity of the project was rated as Low for the proposed development and associated infrastructure.



Figure 9. Vegetation conditions of the proposed conference site.

SITE SENSITIVITY VERIFICATION REPORT: PROPOSED DUTYWA CONFERENCE CENTRE

(a) SITE SENSITIVITY

According to the National Screening Tool, the Terrestrial Biodiversity Sensitivity is rated as Very High, indicating that the site may contain ecologically important natural habitat. Although portions of the project area occur adjacent to the urban edge of Dutywa and are influenced by existing roads, informal tracks and other anthropogenic disturbances, the proposed development footprint extends across undeveloped grassland habitat and near drainage features associated with the Mputi river.

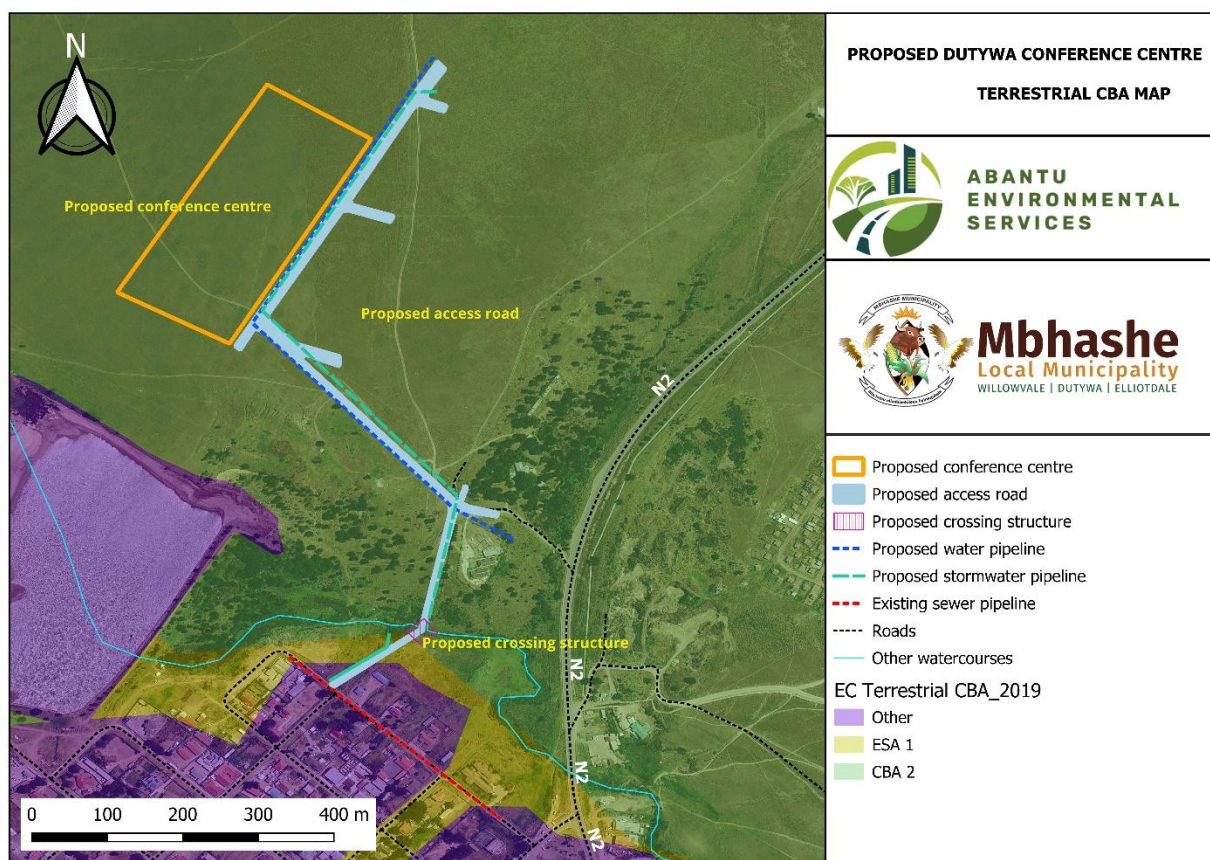


Figure 10. Terrestrial Biodiversity of the proposed conference centre and associated infrastructure.

(b) AQUATIC BIODIVERSITY

The project area is located in an aquatic Ecological Support Area (ESA) 1 according to the 2019 Eastern Cape Biodiversity Conservation Plan. As reported by the national web based environmental screening tool, the aquatic biodiversity sensitivity on the site is very high. The proposed crossing structure traverses Mputi river (Figure 12), a tributary of the Ngxakaxa river. The site is located on an Ecological Support Area 1 (ESA 1) denoting a delicate ecosystem (Figure 11).

SITE SENSITIVITY VERIFICATION REPORT: PROPOSED DUTYWA CONFERENCE CENTRE

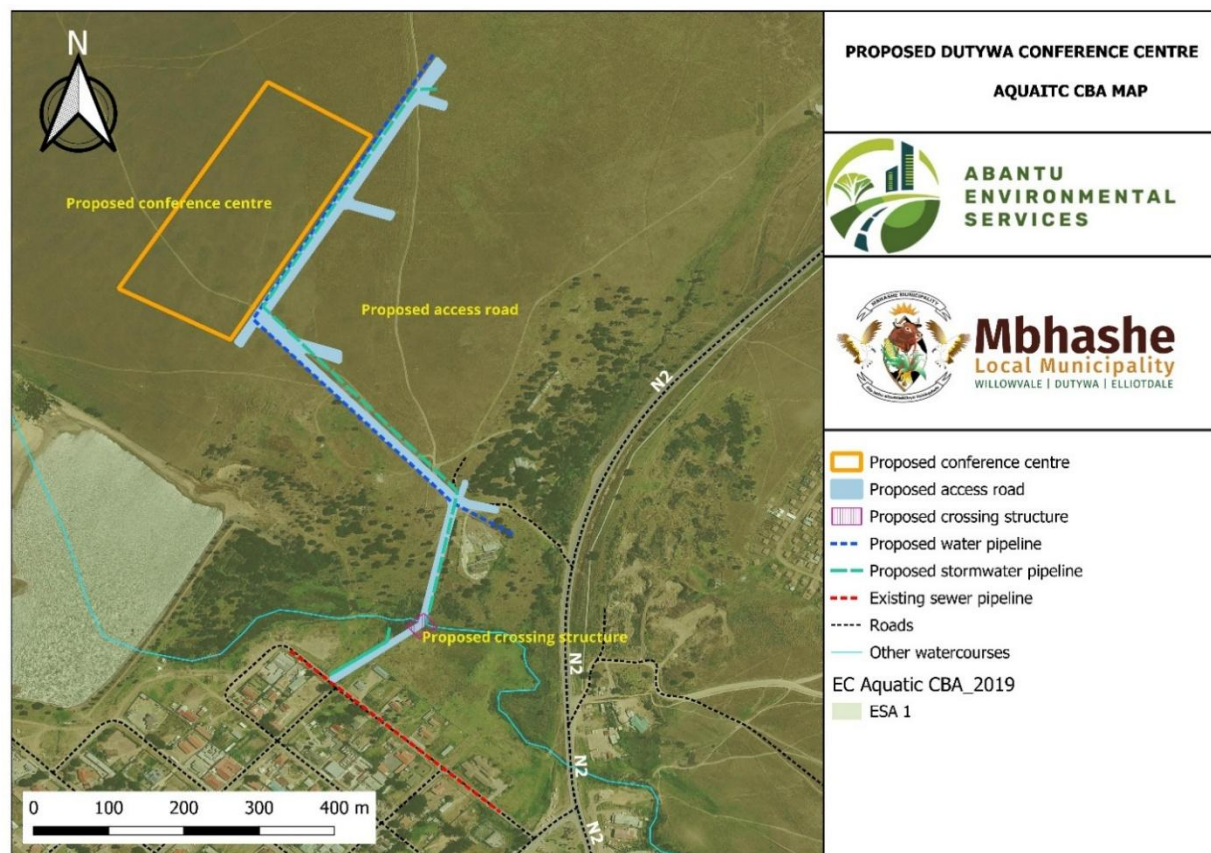


Figure 11. Aquatic sensitivity of the proposed conference centre and associated infrastructure.



Figure 12. The river that the associated infrastructure will traverse.

4.2.5 SOCIO-ECONOMIC ASPECTS

The proposed project is located in Dutywa within the Mbhashe Local Municipality, in the Eastern Cape Province of South Africa. Mbhashe Local Municipality falls under the Amathole District Municipality and includes the main towns of Dutywa, Willowvale and Elliotdale, together with extensive surrounding rural settlements and agricultural areas. Dutywa serves as one of the key administrative and commercial centres within the municipality. The municipality is characterised by a predominantly rural settlement pattern, with a dispersed population and a network of local and regional roads connecting the towns and surrounding villages. Significant routes in the broader municipal area include the N2 national route, which provides regional connectivity through the Eastern Cape, as well as a number of provincial and local access roads linking Dutywa to nearby settlements and service centres. The municipality is divided into a number of wards that support local governance and service delivery within the municipal area.

(a) Population

According to Census (2022), the municipality has total population of 240 020 with a household of 52 715 resulting to a household size increase of 4.6% (Census, 2022). When compared to other regions, it accounts for 27.5% of the total population in the district. Dutywa has a population of approximately 11 076 people (Census 2011), with 54.1% of the population being females and 45.9% being males.

(b) Education

According to Census 2022, the municipality records that about 5.6% of the population have received Higher Education schooling, 16.5% have Matric, 37% have received Secondary schooling, 6,4% have completed Primary school, and 16% have no schooling.

(c) Economic aspect

In 2021, Mbhashe Local Municipality employed a total number of 20 600 people within its local municipality. The community services sector recorded the largest number of employments in 2021 with a total of 7 540 employees. The trade sector with a total of 5 120 employees, the electricity sector with 53 people and the mining sector employing just 26 people. For the period 2011 to 2021 the number of households earning more than R30,000 per annum has increased from 67.61% to 87.50%. The number of households with income equal to or lower than R6,000 per year has decreased by a significant amount (MLM IDP, 2026).

4.2.6 CULTURAL HERITAGE SITE

The National Screening Tool rates the Archaeological and Cultural Heritage theme sensitivity as Low for the Conference Centre and all associated infrastructure. The SAHRIS Palaeo map rates the palaeontology theme as Very High (**Figure 13**. SAHRIS Palaeo map.), which necessitates a filed assessment and protocol for finds within the proposed project area.

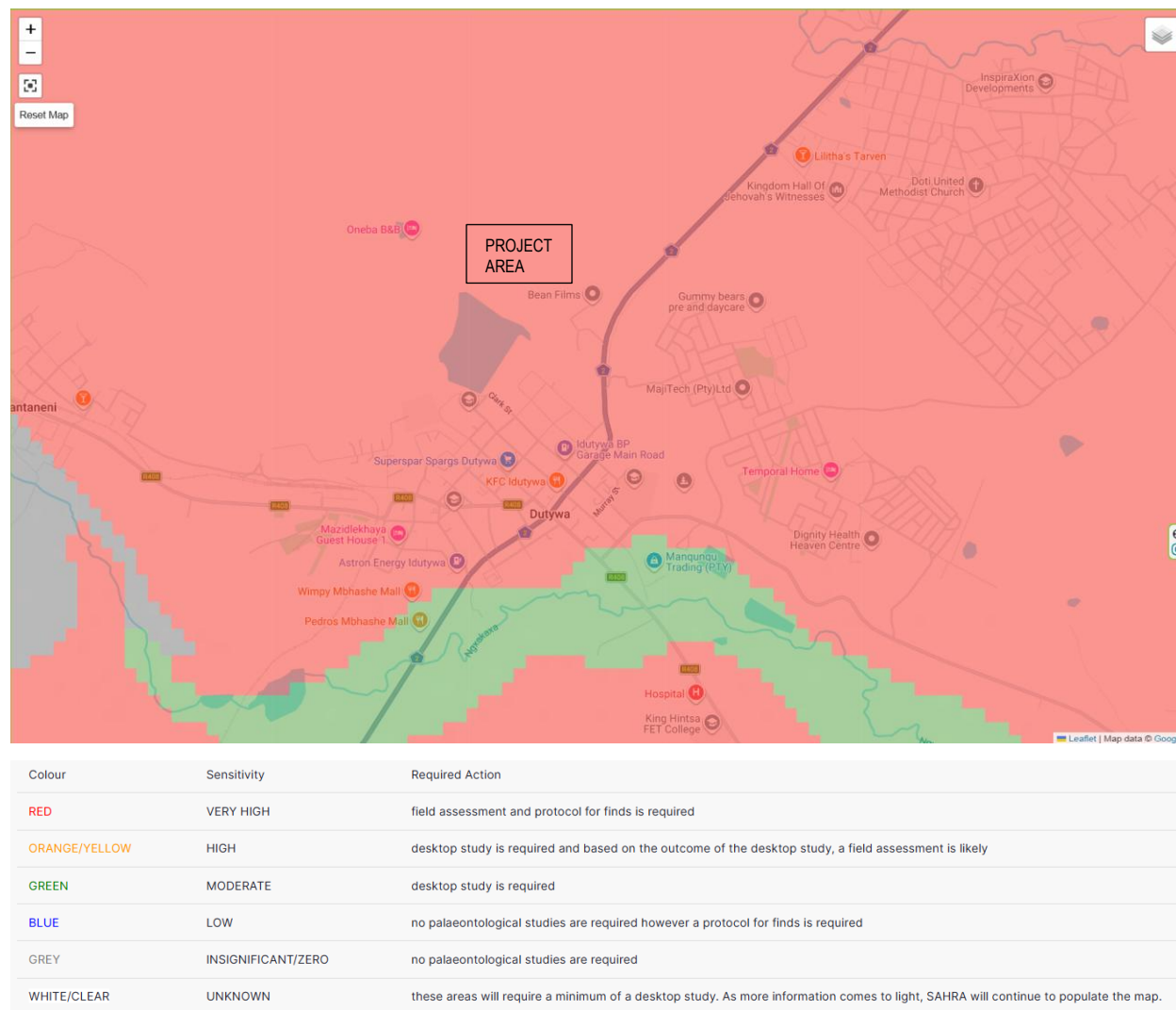


Figure 13. SAHRIS Palaeo map.

4.2.7 LAND USE

The development site is located on greenfield northeast of the Dutywa town and its sub-urban area. It is accessed via gravel road branching off from the N2 (**Figure 14**). However, the municipality proposes to construct a new access road from the conference centre to the town, which crosses the Mputi river at approximately 138 m north of the bridge along N2.



Figure 14. Gravel access road to the conference centre from N2.



Figure 15. Existing overhead powerlines within the vicinity of the proposed site.

4.3. SITE SENSITIVITIES IDENTIFIED (SCREENING TOOL)

This section entails the sensitivities, and the required specialists identified by the screening tool (Table 2).

Table 2. Site Sensitivities identified (Screening Tool)

Category	Conference centre	Access road	Crossing structure	Sewer pipe	Stormwater pipe	Water pipe
Agriculture theme	High	High	High		High	High
Animal Species theme	High	High	High	High	High	High
Aquatic Biodiversity theme	Very High	Very High	Very High	Very High	Very High	Very High
Archaeological and Cultural Heritage theme	Low	Low	Low	Low	Low	Low
Civil aviation theme	High	High	High	High	High	High
Defense theme	Low	Low	Low	Low	Low	Low
Paleontology theme	Very High	Very High	Very High	Very High	Very High	Very High
Plant Species theme	Low	Low	Low	Low	Low	Low
Terrestrial Biodiversity theme	Very High	Very High	Very High	Very High	Very High	Very High

4.4. SPECIALIST ASSESSMENTS IDENTIFIED

Based on the above environmental sensitivities, the proposed development footprint, the following list of specialist assessments have been identified for inclusion in the assessment report by the screening tool.

- Agricultural Impact Assessment
- Archaeological and Cultural Heritage Impact Assessment
- Paleontology Impact Assessment
- Terrestrial Biodiversity Impact Assessment
- Aquatic Biodiversity Impact Assessment
- Socio-Economic Assessment
- Plant Species Assessment
- Animal Species Assessment

The specialist studies listed in **Table 3** are required for the selected project area. Motivation has been included in cases where the recommended specialist study will not be undertaken.

SITE SENSITIVITY VERIFICATION REPORT: PROPOSED DUTYWA CONFERENCE CENTRE

Table 3. EAP response to specialist assessments identified in the screening tool report.

Specialist Studies Required	Indication of Whether Studies Will Be Conducted or Not (Yes/No)	Motivation for any Studies That Will Not Be Undertaken
Agricultural Impact Assessment	No	The DFFE Screening tool identified the Agricultural theme as High. The site conditions and land use context do not align with active or viable agricultural land. The site is not currently under cultivation, nor is it zoned or utilized for agricultural purposes. Therefore, an Agricultural Impact Assessment is not warranted, as the proposed development will not lead to the loss of viable agricultural land or impact existing agricultural activities in the area.
Archaeological and Cultural Heritage Impact Assessment	Yes	The DFFE Screening tool identified the Archaeological and Cultural Heritage theme as Low. A Notice of Intent to Develop under Section 38 of the NHRA will be submitted to ECPHRA. Therefore, an Archeological and Cultural Heritage Impact assessment will be undertaken.
Paleontology Impact Assessment	Yes	The DFFE Screening tool identified area of Very High paleontological sensitivity, necessitating a specialist assessment to determine potential subsurface fossil presence. Therefore, a Paleontological study will be undertaken.
Terrestrial Biodiversity Impact Assessment	Yes	The DFFE Screening tool identified the project area as having a Very High Terrestrial Biodiversity and being in a Critical Biodiversity Area (CBA 2) and an Ecological Support Area (ESA 1). The natural vegetation type occurring in the area is the Mthatha Moist Grassland, which forms part of the Grassland Biome and supports a variety of indigenous plant and animal species. The proposed conference centre and associated infrastructure traverse largely undeveloped grassland with scattered vegetation, warranting a detailed ecological assessment.
Aquatic Biodiversity Impact Assessment	Yes	The DFFE Screening tool identified the Aquatic Biodiversity theme as Very High and being in an Ecological Support Area (ESA 1). The proposed crossing structure and portions of the sewer, water and stormwater infrastructure are to cross or occur adjacent to a drainage line/wetland. An Aquatic assessment is required to determine ecological sensitivity, aquatic habitat condition and appropriate mitigation measures.
Socio-Economic Assessment	No	The proposed project is of a relatively limited scale and is anticipated to result in positive socio-economic benefit for Dutywa and the surrounding Mbhashe Local Municipality area through employment opportunities and improved infrastructure and service provision. No significant negative socio-economic impacts are anticipated.

SITE SENSITIVITY VERIFICATION REPORT: PROPOSED DUTYWA CONFERENCE CENTRE

Specialist Studies Required	Indication of Whether Studies Will Be Conducted or Not (Yes/No)	Motivation for any Studies That Will Not Be Undertaken
Plant Species Assessment	No	The DFFE Screening Tool identified the Plant theme as Low sensitivity. The assessment of plant species will be incorporated in the Terrestrial Biodiversity Impact Assessment study.
Animal Species Assessment	Yes	The DFFE Screening tool identified the Animal theme as High. The proposed site falls under the Grassland Biome and may support small mammals, reptiles, and avifauna typical of the Mthatha Moist Grassland. The assessment of animal species will be incorporated in the Terrestrial Biodiversity Impact Assessment study.

Therefore, this site sensitivity verification report is compiled to determine whether Specialist Assessments or Compliance Statements for the abovementioned specialist studies are required for the proposed project.

5. CONCLUSION

An environmental scoping site visit was undertaken on 28 July 2026. The purpose of the site visit was to gather enough information to develop a complete, comprehensive understanding of the receiving environment of the site and inform the project's environmental impact assessment process. This preliminary assessment forms the basis against which the EIA will be conducted. From the site verification conducted, it is apparent that the pipeline route presents shared sensitivities, specifically;

- watercourse crossings
- intact vegetation forms

In light of the above, the following are evident

- The pipeline regulatory triggers and applicability are confined, necessitating an EA and WULA prior to construction commencement

Based on the verification of the identified sensitivities by the National Screening Tool report. Selected specialist studies should be commissioned to inform the environmental impact assessment due to high and every high sensitivity as verified on site. Identified specialists are:

- Terrestrial Biodiversity Impact Assessment – Inclusive of Plants and Animal species
- Aquatic Biodiversity Impact Assessment

SITE SENSITIVITY VERIFICATION REPORT: PROPOSED DUTYWA CONFERENCE CENTRE

- Full Paleontological Impact Assessment
- Full Archaeological and Cultural Heritage Impact Assessment

6. REFERENCES

Mbhashe Local Municipality. (2023). Integrated Development Plan. Available from: <https://www.mbhashemun.gov.za/>

South African National Biodiversity Institute (bgis.sanbi.org).

Stats SA (2022). Census 2022. Accessed 13 July 2026. Available from: <https://census.statssa.gov.za/#/province/2/>

Stats SA (2011). Census 2011. Accessed 13 July 2026. Available from: https://www.statssa.gov.za/?page_id=4286&id=915